DESLORATADINE

Non-sedating
Once daily

CHEMICAL NAME 8-chloro-6,11-dihydro-11-(piperidin-4-ylidene)-5H-benzo[5,6]cyclohepta[1,2-b]pyridine

CLASS Second-generation (non-sedating) H1 antihistamine

TRADE NAMES Aerius · Clarinex · Deslor · Desa

THERAPEUTIC USES / INDICATIONS

- Allergic rhinitis (seasonal, perennial).
- Chronic idiopathic urticaria.

ADMINISTRATION

- **PO** tablets, syrup or orodispersible tablets once daily, with or without food.

DOSAGES

- **Adult & ≥12 yr:** 5 mg once daily.
- **6–11 yr:** 2.5 mg once daily.
- **1–5 yr:** 1.25 mg once daily (syrup).

PHARMACOKINETICS

- **Onset:** 1 h. **Duration:** 24 h.
- Metabolised in liver to 3-hydroxydesloratadine; some people are slow metabolisers.
- Excreted in urine and faeces. **t½:** 27 h.

PHARMACODYNAMICS

- Long-acting selective peripheral **H1 antagonist**; anti-inflammatory effects on mast cells.

SIDE & ADVERSE EFFECTS

SIDE EFFECTS (COMMON)

- Headache, fatigue.
- Dry mouth.
- Pharyngitis.

ADVERSE EFFECTS (SERIOUS)

- Tachycardia (rare).
- Seizures (rare; caution in epilepsy).
- Hypersensitivity.

CONTRAINDICATIONS & CAUTIONS

- Hypersensitivity to desloratadine or loratadine.
- **Caution:** severe renal impairment, epilepsy.

KEY INTERACTIONS

- No clinically important interactions (including alcohol).

NURSING MANAGEMENT

- Assess allergy symptoms and urticaria.
- Advise about rare drowsiness.

PATIENT EDUCATION

- Take once daily.
- Usually does not cause drowsiness.

KEY POINTS

- Active metabolite of loratadine.
- Non-sedating.
- 5 mg once daily.
- Few interactions.